

Chapter 9: Some Special Driving Situations

Driving at night is much more dangerous than driving during the day. Many people do not see as well at night. When taking a trip, it is safer to drive during daylight hours. Also, never drive when you are tired.

Headlights

Slow down when driving at night and be sure you can stop within the distance lit by your headlights.

You must use your headlights beginning 30 minutes after sunset and ending 30 minutes before sunrise, or anytime when individuals or vehicles cannot be seen clearly for at least 1,000 feet.

Avoid looking directly into the headlights of approaching vehicles; shift your eyes down to the lower right side of your traffic lane.

Use your low beam headlights when:

1. Within 500 feet of an approaching vehicle
2. Following closely (within 300 feet) behind another vehicle
3. Driving on lighted roads
4. Driving in fog, heavy rain, sleet, snow, or dust

If you must park on an unlighted highway at night, leave your parking lights or low beam headlights on.

Highway Driving

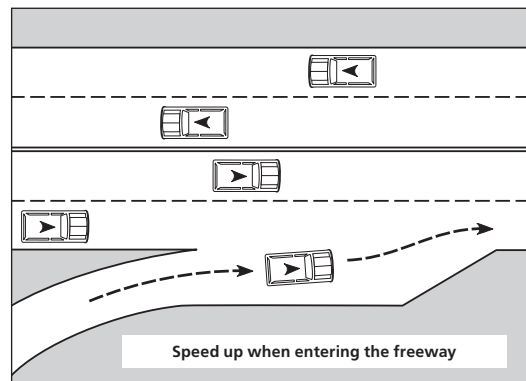
Freeways, toll-roads, throughways, turnpikes, and expressways are designed for maximum safety, but you must know how to use them properly. In Texas, a highway is defined as the width between the boundary lines of a publicly maintained way, any part of which is open to the public for vehicular travel.

Before Using a Highway

Plan your trip in advance so you know your entrance, direction, and exit. Make sure you and your car are in good condition. If you cannot or do not want to drive at or above the minimum speed limit, do not use the highway.

Entering the Highway

1. You must yield the right-of-way to vehicles already on the highway.
2. Enter the speed change lane, stay to the right, signal left, and when it is clear, increase your speed to merge with the flow of traffic.



Driving on the Highway

Choose the Proper Lane

1. Use the right lane to drive at the minimum posted speed limit or below the normal flow of traffic.
2. Use the middle or left lane if you are traveling faster than other traffic or passing other vehicles.
3. If you plan to leave the freeway soon, change to the exit lane as soon as possible.